

SEASON 01 EPISODE 04

To Meet a Friend

DEEP, HEAVY BREATHS.

1 EXT. CICADA - DAY

1

A lush forest.

A beaver- PETUNIA- emerges from a pool of water. She pants, treads, then comes to a stop.

An otter- ROSALINE- comes up behind.

Then a platypus- GANKE- surprises them.

GANKE

Be scared! Be terrified!

Petunia and Rosaline laugh, chuckle their way to shore.

2 INT. PETUNIA'S CAR - DAY

2

Petunia and Rosaline sit in the backseat, with boosters. Petunia's aunt- PATTY- glances at a rearview mirror, at the two kids.

PATTY

Are you kids okay?

GIRLS

(in unison)

Yes, Aunt Patty.

3 EXT. TALENS - DAY

3

The car SHOOTS by a sign: "WELCOME TO TALENS."

4 INT. PETUNIA'S CAR - DAY

4

Petunia and Rosaline glance outside Rosaline's side, wowed.

Petunia unbuckles.

PATTY

Petunia, careful!

PETUNIA

I will, auntie!

The girls glance down a slope. They're on a hill. And below them:

- Downtown
- The train tracks
- Westside, past the tracks

5 EXT. EASTSIDE - DAY

5

The car parks at a clean, sloped street.

ROSALINE
Auntie, is this where you live?

PATTY
Sure is, Rosaline.

6 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY

6

The girls flood inside, amazed at the spacious area.

ROSALINE
How did you get so rich?

PATTY
You gotta beat the crowd, kids. And
as soon as I get you in school, you
two are gonna soar way above it!

They pass by a portrait of their family. Throwing
constructio hats in the air. Happy.

Patty kisses her nieces.

The voice of an older woman- EVE- speaks.

EVE (V.O.)
There's a lot of sad in this world.
I think the happy parts deserve
credit, too.

A beautiful, romantic tune plays as:

The beaver and otter run around the house, playing tag.

7 EXT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY

7

Patty sits on the porch.

A car with a MOVE-IN TRUCK rounds the sloped hill.

PATTY
Oh?

Down the street, a dog, his mother, and his father move
in.

JUNIPER'S FAMILY.

Juniper- the kid- gets out of the car first. Glancing down
at the ground.

Jane- his mother- next.

Then Seymour- his father.

Seymour puts his hands on his hips.

SEYMOUR

There we go. A proper home.

Jane doesn't protest. But what she does do is look around, hand on her kid's shoulders-

And makes eye contact with Patty.

Jane waves. Patty- scared, but smiling- waves back.

ON HER PORCH:

JANE

Hey. I'm looking for new people to be friends with my kid? We moved here from the western part of town.

PATTY

Across the tracks? Oh goodness!

JUNIPER

I don't want any new friends...

JANE

June, behave, please.

PATTY

(gasps)

Your name's June!

Patty holds out her hand.

PATTY

Nice to meet you.

Juniper clings to Jane.

So Jane takes it.

JANE

It's nice to meet you too.

Petunia and Rosaline reach the porch, clinging to Patty.

They make eye contact with Juniper. They see the sad in Juniper's eyes.

PETUNIA

(whispering)

He looks sad.

ROSALINE

Say something.

PETUNIA

You say something!

PATTY
Now, now, kids, you'll have plenty
of time to get to know each other.
If you're willing to, that is. What
do you say?

Juniper reluctantly, slowly, nods.

Then Petunia and Rosaline.

8 INT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY

8

Juniper watches his parents move everything in.

Hours pass. The family portrait- BUSINESSMEN- goes up.

Couches, TVs, tables, until the house looks clean and
cared for.

Jane stands in the kitchen with Seymour. They lean against
the counter.

JANE
Baby, I hope this is worth it.

SEYMOUR
It'll be more than worth. Trust me.
Seymour holds Jane's hand. He holds it tight.
Jane's smile fades.

JANE
He really did make some friends, you
know.

SEYMOUR
Some friends or just one?
Jane slouches.

SEYMOUR
He'll make way more this way.
Jane nods. They hug.

PANG! PANG! PANG!

SEYMOUR
What's that?

JANE
Oh, just Juniper playing ball
outside.

Seymour leans in. They slow-dance to nothing.

9 **EXT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY**

9

PANG! PANG!

Juniper tries to catch it, just barely does.

Across the street, Petunia and Rosaline watch.

PANG!

They flinch.

The ball bounces on the garage door, then falls down, past Juniper's grip.

JUNIPER

No, no no no no!

Juniper runs downhill, but trips.

A car around the corner.

Juniper gasps. But this time he reacts fast enough.

The car swings around-

But the ball is nowhere to be seen.

Juniper sits back on the porch and hugs his legs, rocking.

Petunia and Rosaline look at each other. Then they go to him.

PETUNIA

Are you okay?

Juniper shakes his head.

JUNIPER

I miss my friend.

ROSALINE

We can be friends.

Juniper glances at them.

JUNIPER

You really think so?

The two nod.

Juniper smiles.

A distant memory fades into swirls-

10 **EXT. EASTSIDE MIDDLE - DAY**

10

As an older Petunia and Rosaline emerge from the middle school pool.

PETUNIA
June, get inside!

JUNIPER
No!

ROSALINE
June, come on!

JUNIPER
I said no!

PETUNIA
June, just get in!

Petunia and Rosaline grab Juniper's wading legs and THRUST him in. Chuckling and laughing, they splash each other with water.

Laying on the grass, they stare into the open world.

Petunia, in particular, glances on in the horizon.

JUNIPER
You okay?

PETUNIA
Just thinking.

The wind blows. Their half-dried fur rustles.

Petunia spins her finger around a blade of grass.

PETUNIA
June, we're going to Talens High.
Wanna go together?

Juniper nods.

JUNIPER
Why wouldn't I?

The wind blows.

Rosaline and Petunia lean on Juniper.

11 **EXT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY**

11

Juniper waves the girls off. He goes inside.

12 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY 12

Pattie is watching the news. Petunia stares at the portrait of her family, with construction hats.

13 INT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY 13

Juniper passes by the portrait of his family on the staircase- but doesn't glance.

14 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY 14

Rosaline enters the kitchen.

ROSALINE

Auntie-

15 INT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY 15

Juniper pours himself some afternoon cereal.

JUNIPER

Mom- what are you watching?

JANE

Oh, the news, the usual. You go swimming with the girls?

JUNIPER

Yeah.

ON TV:

Angry protests from large and small animals.

REPORTER

The budget revision bill, after failing almost six times in the senate, finally passed.

JANE

June, you hear that? Mommy and Daddy's salaries go up!

JUNIPER

What about Petunia and Rosaline?

JANE

Their families are protected, if that's what you're wondering. Look-

Onscreen is a pie chart. Jane turns up the volume.

REPORTER

Beavers and otters seeing a raise of almost a full percent in their portion of the salary distribution-

JUNIPER
Well, that's...

Juniper glances at the salaries for BEARS AND RABBITS.
There's a red arrow next to them. They went down.
Juniper glances into his cereal. Then up at his mother.

16 EXT. EASTSIDE MIDDLE - DAY 16

Juniper stands before his middle school.

17 EXT. TALENS HIGH - DAY 17

And just like that, a year has passed by.

18 INT. TALENS HIGH - DAY 18

Juniper walks down the halls of Talens High. Animals of big and small roam the halls.

He grabs his clean backpack and wanders through the school.

Petunia and Rosaline, in front, whisper to each other.

PETUNIA
(whispering)
This is scary.

Rosaline nods.

Inside a classroom- HISTORY AB.

Juniper sits down. He glances around the room, then back to his seat.

Behind him sits none other than LOUIS- his old friend, a bear with a snapback.

Louis rummages through his backpack, then glances upward.

His eyes go wide.

At the corner of a room: A rabbit- EVE- sits down, quiet, hunched forward.

TEACHER
Alright, everyone! Take a long, hard
look at those around you!

Louis, Juniper, Eve, Petunia, Rosaline- they all glance.

Juniper reaches to the person in front of him.

JUNIPER

Hi! I'm June! Nice to meet you.

Louis's eyes- first with disbelief- sparkle.

JUNIPER

June. Yeah, June. This is Petunia
and Rosaline.

Louis glances over at the beaver and otter by him. Wonder
turns to surprise. Then Juniper turns around.

JUNIPER

I'm J-

Juniper reaches out to shake hands. But as he glances up
at the bear-

Louis, smirking, takes his hand. Juniper grins, and for a
moment, the world stops.

LOUIS

Cool.

JUNIPER

(smiling)

Cool.

Juniper looks around. Looks like everyone else is talking.

JUNIPER

I lost my ball.

LOUIS

No worries. I kept the other one.

Juniper smiles, nods, slowly turns around, smiling.

An image of a MAP of the mainland, with demographics,
appears over a projector screen.

TEACHER

Looks like everyone's noticed by
now, but this school is one of the
most diverse schools in the entire
region of the mainland, only second
to Fjord, which is considered the
largest city on the mainland!

At the corner of the room, people reach toward one
another. Eve- the rabbit in the corner of the room-
glances around. She doesn't try to meet anyone. She just
pulls down on her ears.

TEACHER

With that being said, we're gonna
(MORE)

TEACHER (CONT'D)
 learn a lot about Fjord, and the
 entirety of mammalia, how some
 migrated to here from distant
 islands...

THE BELL RINGS.

Students get up. Petunia and Rosaline fold notebooks.

PETUNIA
 Jeez, history is boring...

ROSALINE
 Hey, Petunia?

Petunia glances at the corner of the room.

TEACHER
 Hey! Hey!

Eve, in the corner of the room, is surrounded by animals
 of all kinds.

FOX
 Big-ears!

WOLF
 Yeah, kid, who even needs those?

The teacher breaks up the fight.

TEACHER
 Break it up, you two.

Eve glances in the kids' direction. She notices Petunia
 and Rosaline.

19 EXT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

19

Louis and Juniper walk down the steps.

JUNIPER
 This is Louis!

LOUIS
 Who's Petunia and who's Rosaline?

Louis holds out his hand.

PETUNIA
 Wait! It's kind of awkward! Just met
 us at the cafeteria!

BOYS
 (in unison)
 Okay!

LOUIS
No way. It's been like-

JUNIPER
Five years and counting? I haven't
seen you in so long!

LOUIS
You could have visited.

JUNIPER
I couldn't have, dude. My mom
doesn't even want me near downtown,
for fuck's sake.

LOUIS
Your mom's a prick, and she can go
suck a fat one.

JUNIPER
You can suck a fat one! Race you!

Juniper nudges Louis. Louis runs after.

But he bumps into Juniper. He stops, then notices:

In the quad, a TIGER and a DOG fight.

CROWD
Fight! Fight! Fight! Fight!

The tiger gets a SOLID HIT in. But the dog ducks past the
second swing.

Swing. Swing. Dog dodges- but then goes low, tries to lift
the tiger off the ground.

Gets PUNISHED. Tiger flips the dog on his back and PINS
HIM.

CROWD
Go! Go! Go!

A group of their friends pull them back. They yell.

Louis and Juniper glance around. Mice cower. Lions smirk.
Cats side-eye. Rabbits are wide-eyed. Raccoons cheer.

They break away from the crowd and into the hall.

20 INT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

20

The two stand in line.

JUNIPER
This is very different from my
elementary school.

LOUIS
In what way?

JUNIPER
Not a single fight.

LOUIS
Are you kidding me? Dude, people
used to throw fucking dodgeballs at
me during recess.

JUNIPER
Are you used to seeing an actual
fistfight?

LOUIS
Fuck no. I mean, it's cool.

JUNIPER
(confused)
Cool?

LUNCHLADY
Next!

Louis walks up. Juniper breaks off.

JUNIPER
I'll see you at the tables! Find me
with Petunia!

Louis scratches his head.

LOUIS
Wait, wha-

LUNCHLADY
Next, kid!

Louis grabs cafeteria lunch, then finds Juniper.

Juniper's meal is home-made.

Petunia and Rosaline talk like normal.

PETUNIA
I love XRX, but not ENZO.

ROSALINE
Really?

PETUNIA
I thought we talked about this.
You're the ENZO one. I'm XRX.

The girls make eye contact with Louis.

PETUNIA
Hey, which bands do you like?

LOUIS
Bands?

ROSALINE
You don't listen to music?

LOUIS
N-nah. Not like, often.

PETUNIA
Old school or new school?

LOUIS
Old school.

PETUNIA
Then you've probably heard ENZO. I'm
also an old school girlie.

Petunia hums a tune to ENZO.

PETUNIA
Familiar?

Louis shakes his head. Petunia laughs.

And Louis, though a rare phenomenon from him- grins.

Petunia and Rosaline continue talking. Louis turns to
Juniper.

He glances at Juniper's meal.

JUNIPER
Wanna try? It's halibut.

Louis's grin turns into a full smile.

JUNIPER
What?

LOUIS
N-nothing. Ima just steal this real
quick...

THE BELL RINGS.

The group sits after school.

ROSALINE
And then there's homecoming and
homecoming games and-

JUNIPER
You gonna do student body?

ROSALINE
Dude, honestly?

As the group talks, Louis fazes them out. He notices a rabbit walking across him. Eve.

ROSALINE
Catch you later!

JUNIPER
See ya!

Juniper turns to Louis.

JUNIPER
Wanna walk home?

Louis snaps to.

LOUIS
Sure.

Suddenly, HAZEL- Louis's sister- appears from behind them.

HAZEL
What up, bitches!

Two bears- SIENNA and KODY- behind Hazel- appear.

Hazel puts her arms around Louis.

HAZEL
So? How was your first day?

LOUIS
A lot.

HAZEL
I know, right? I told you. Anyway
who's this?

Juniper holds out his hand.

JUNIPER
I used to live across from you guys.

21 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

21

Years ago, Hazel turns the corner as the voice of Jane yells:

JANE
Like I said, in line!

A tire screech.

22 INT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

22

HAZEL

You're the handball guy?

Juniper nods. Hazel nods, taking his hand. But shaking it firm- a little too firm.

Juniper wrestles her off.

HAZEL

You gonna walk home?

Louis stares back between Hazel and Juniper.

LOUIS

Yeah, I can walk-

Hazel cuts him off. It causes Juniper to flinch.

HAZEL

Nah, don't sweat it. I'm heading back with Sienna and Kody. Gonna stay at the park.

Louis nods. Hazel splits off.

The wind blows. Juniper awkwardly sits, quiet.

LOUIS

(clears throat)

Yeah, that's my bitch of a sister.

JUNIPER

She seems chill.

Louis gets up.

LOUIS

Come on.

23 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY

23

Louis and Juniper walk down the streets of the city. In front of them: Eve, that same rabbit.

Juniper and Louis stare in the distance, at Eve.

LOUIS

We used to be chill, but since she graduated middle school, it's like a switch flipped in her. She wouldn't stop hanging around those bears.

JUNIPER

Bears?

LOUIS

Sienna and Kody. They're both black bears, but Kody's a sub-breed called a "Kermode" bear, apparently.

(scoffs)

Just a bunch of bullshit. Hazel tries to talk about them but I swear they go driving at night and hotbox a car together.

JUNIPER

Hotbox?

LOUIS

It's when you-

(makes smoke sign)

-no?

Juniper doesn't notice. Louis pats him on the back.

LOUIS

Nevermind then.

They turn the corner. Louis stops at the tracks.

JUNIPER

Well, this is where I break off.

Louis nods. He begins crossing.

JUNIPER

Hey- is that legal?

Louis shrugs.

LOUIS

It's what I've been doing since I was little.

Louis crosses the tracks. He turns around.

LOUIS

Still wanna be friends?

JUNIPER

I do! Don't get me wrong, I just- it's been a while.

Louis pauses, glances down at the ground at Juniper's kindness.

But he looks back up and smiles.

LOUIS
Glad to have you back.

Louis crosses the bushes.

24 EXT. WESTSIDE - DAY

24

Louis glances at the rabbit ahead of him. He scratches his head.

The rabbit enters a worn, shoddy house at the corner of the street.

LOUIS
Huh.

25 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY

25

Louis enters the door, closes it.

In the kitchen, Belinda cooks halibut.

BELINDA
How was it?

LOUIS
I met June again!

Belinda pauses. Her eyes go wide.

Then she resumes cutting.

BELINDA
Okay then! So I made the right choice by sending you to Hazel's high school?

LOUIS
Yes, you did Mom. I'm not going anywhere.

BELINDA
Okay.

Belinda plates the halibut.

BELINDA
Since you are a big boy, I'm gonna need you to help me and your daddy upcycle.

LOUIS
Is that even legal?

BELINDA
It's what we've been doing since we
(MORE)

BELINDA (CONT'D)
 got here. Then this weekend, we're
 hosting a party for your Uncle
 Ridge, who's visiting from Lakos...

Louis's ears droop.

BELINDA
 Oh, come on, Louis. He's just
 visiting for a day.

LOUIS
 (mumbling)
 I know.

Belinda gets up and places her dishes in the sink.

BELINDA
 And I'm gonna need you to wash
 these, since Hazel's never home now.

Louis groans, washes the dishes.

Belinda turns on the news.

REPORTER
 President Bullock's current salary
 bill is cutting ursid and leporid
 salaries in half-

Belinda changes the channel.

BELINDA
 Nope.

Louis quietly chuckles. Belinda settles with her show.

Louis goes into his bedroom. He brings out a notebook and
 begins to draw.

26 EXT. PARK - DAY

26

Hazel, Sienna, and Kody take turns smoking.

HAZEL
 Raspberry. Raspberry. Bro, gimme
 raspberry!

SIENNA
 I'm loading it. Goddamn it.

Sienna takes a long drag. Hazel immediately grabs it, then
 blows it.

Kody last. The three of them pull their hoodies up and
 Sienna takes out a group of cards.

SIENNA
Bruh, Hazel, now that your brother's
in highschool, we gotta be careful.

HAZEL
My brother won't snitch.

Sienna takes another long drag.

SIENNA
He better not.

Sienna blows.

27 INT. EVE'S HOME - DAY

27

Eve heads inside. She sighs, then brings out a textbook from school.

HISTORY OF FJORD.

She flips through the pages, one by one.

Then closes the book.

She places the book on the desk. ON THAT SAME DESK:

A soft-cover with the same name. Alongside a stack of other homeschooled books.

EVE
(mutters)
Why the hell am I studying this when
I already know it...

Eve takes out a math book. Linear algebra.

She flips the pages, notices practice problem after practice problem.

EVE
(mutters)
But then this is...

Eve shuts the book, frustrated. She can't even understand half the words.

She grabs her guitar and begins strumming. She pulls up an old VHS tape of a singer.

ADELINE is her name, and she's a secretarybird.

EVE
I'll sing to the cities, where
worlds come crashing... To the
jungles... Concrete jungles.

SHE'S OLD SCHOOL.

28 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY

28

Petunia and Rosaline sit in the lobby, doing homework.

PETUNIA

We should try and get to know her.

ROSALINE

Weren't you friends with rabbits in middle school?

PETUNIA

Yeah, but they were mean.

ROSALINE

So then why reach out?

PETUNIA

Because, I don't know, she seems shy. Didn't auntie always say to be sensitive?

ROSALINE

Yeah, but I don't think it applies in this case.

PETUNIA

It does.

ROSALINE

No, it doesn't.

Petunia's auntie turns the corner.

PATTY

You two talking shit about me?

Patty pets Petunia's head.

PETUNIA

Auntie, high school's scary.

ROSALINE

There are so many big animals, and I don't think I've seen a class where literally everyone is a different species.

PATTY

Well, what I tell you? To-

PETUNIA

-Always be sensitive. See, Rosie?

Rosaline rolls her eyes, grunts.

Patty pets them.

PATTY
You two, I didn't just get this
place for free.

ROSALINE
(mutters)
Oh, there she goes again...

PATTY
No, really! We're lucky we're born
beavers! Because even though we're
small, we're always known to be-

PETUNIA
-Hard workers. See?

Rosaline grunts again.

PATTY
And what does society value? Not
praise, not excellence-

ROSALINE
But consistency.

Rosaline sticks out her tongue at Petunia.

PATTY
Will you two just focus? I'm trying
to remind you-

ROSLAINE
Why don't you remind Petunia to get
her smelly socks out of my bedroom?

PETUNIA
Why don't you remind Rosaline to get
her stinky deodorant off my floor?

Rosaline and Petunia play-fight, one that turns into
laughter.

Patty sighs in relief. She heads to the kitchen.

EVE (V.O.)
I think, for a moment, they debated
getting to know me.

29 EXT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

29

Over lunch, while Eve is quiet, Petunia and Rosaline sit
with her.

EVE (V.O.)
But they were the ones who reached
out.

The group sits after school. Louis shakes hands with Eve.

LOUIS
You're pretty.

EVE
(dry)
You have small ears.

Louis smiles.

JUNIPER
Juniper.

EVE
Evelyn Faux Dolores III.

JUNIPER
Woah, really?

EVE
Fuck no. Just Eve.

Juniper smiles.

30 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY

30

The group walks downtown together. They emerge from an ice cream store, licking cones of different sizes.

EVE (V.O.)
And for our first year of high
school, everything was kind of
perfect.

MONTAGE:

Fights on the quad.

EVE (V.O.)
There'd be the occasional fight
between big and medium... Or medium
and small... Or big, medium, and
small...

31 EXT. TALENS HIGH - DAY

31

EVE (V.O.)
But for a moment, I think I actually
felt that shit could hit the ceiling
and we'd totally be okay.

32 EXT. WESTSIDE - DAY**32**

The group waves goodbye to each other. They split.

Juniper, Petunia, and Rosaline break off from Louis and Eve at the tracks- but don't cross it.

Louis crosses. Splits from Eve on the road back.

Juniper catches up to Petunia and Rosaline.

33 EXT. EASTSIDE - DAY**33**

They wave goodbye, then enter the doors to their homes.

And just like that, the last bit of peace ends.

34 INT. EVE'S HOME - DAY**34**

Eve gets home. ERNIE, her sister, sits in the lobby, watching news.

Ernie lets out a huge HACKLE.

ERNIE

Eve, come sit here.

Eve sits down.

35 INT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY**35**

As on TV, the logo of a bold, red H covers the news:

TV - ELECTION SEASON 2020

As the election of a new presidential candidate strikes the news.

JANE

It's happening, June.

36 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY**36**

The same TV.

BELINDA

Ready, Louis?

Louis glances over. His eyes lose his spark.

On TV, a bull, the president- BULLOCK, an ox- running for the conservative party-

37 INT. JUNIPER'S HOME - DAY**37**

A dog, GURNICK, running for the moderate party-

38 INT. EVE'S HOME - DAY

38

And a bird, Adeline- running for the reformist party.

Eve glances on the TV. And as Adeline hits her last note
in the tape-

CUT TO BLACK.

Election season begins.